Dominion Energy Virginia reliability: what public data shows, and where I'd look first

Independent analysis of public data

Saketh Bollina

November 3, 2026

Data: EIA-861 · PUDL · NOAA Storm Events · EAGLE-I · EIA-930

Outage minutes rose from 130 to 133; 2025 had more storms and more interruptions

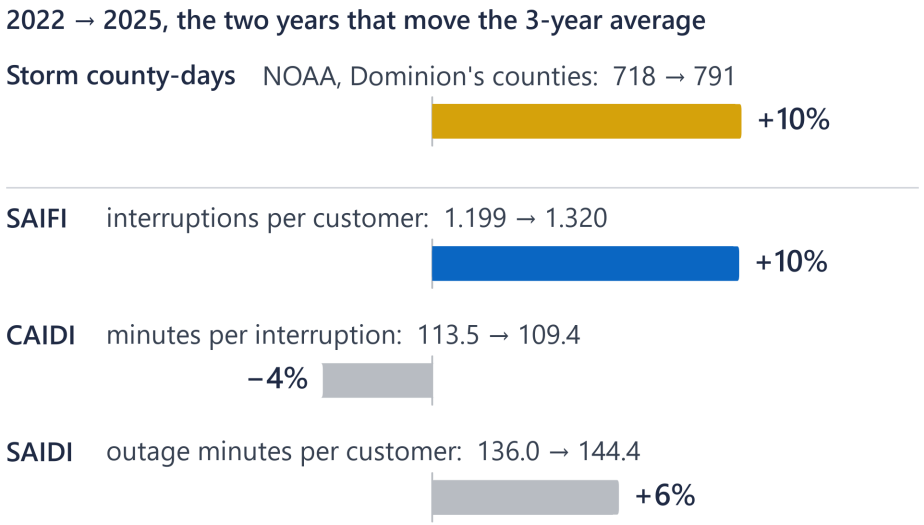
130 → 133

Reported 3-year average outage minutes per customer, excluding major events

Rebuilt from EIA-861: 130.2 → 133.0

2025 (144.4) replaced 2022 (136.0) in the window.

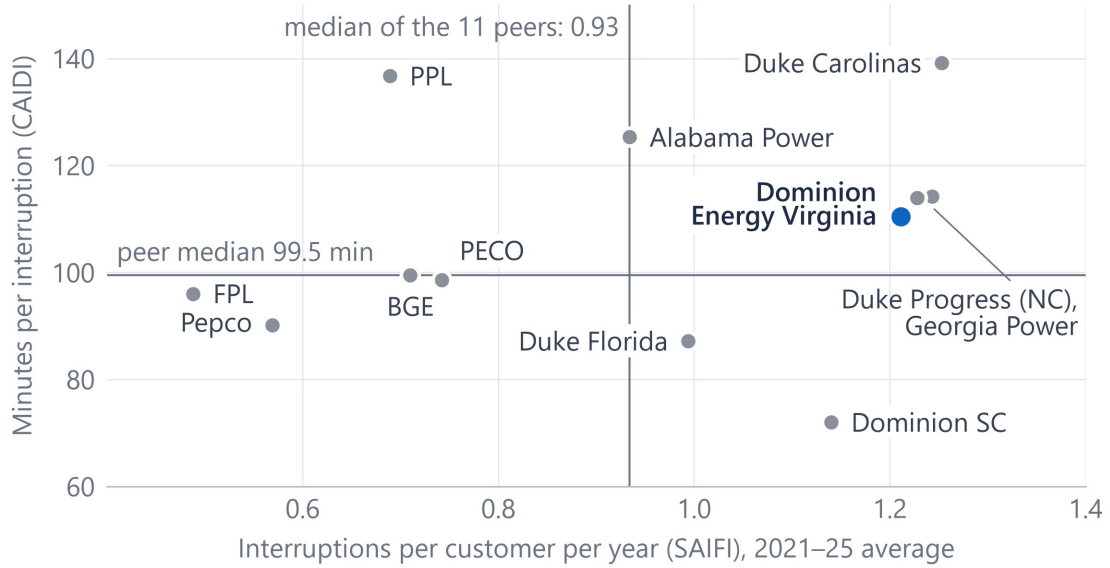
Dominion attributes the rise primarily to increased storm activity (2025 Annual Report, p. 10). 2025 sits on the storm line, with no clear trend once storms are counted (A2).



Why it matters: a stormy year can move a 3-year average. With outage records, I'd ask whether non-storm interruptions are rising underneath.

Source: EIA-861 2025 final and PUDL (EIA-861) 2013–2024, Dominion Energy Virginia, excluding major event days; 3-year means of annual values. NOAA Storm Events (A2). Reported figures: Dominion Energy 2025 Annual Report, p. 10.

Among 12 large utilities, Dominion's interruption length is mid-pack; frequency is the gap



1.21

interruptions per customer a year: 4th highest of the 12 (peer median 0.93)

110 min

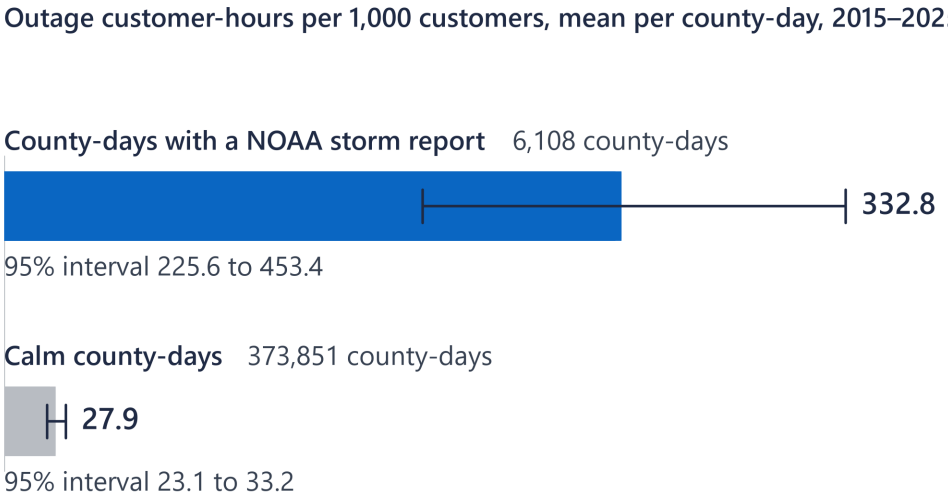
per interruption: mid-pack, 6th of the 12 (peer median 99.5)

Methods differ: Dominion uses its own (non-IEEE) major-event rule, most peers IEEE 1366, so ranks are indicative.

Why it matters: if frequency is where Dominion differs, the next question is which causes drive interruptions, and that needs outage records.

Source: EIA-861 / PUDL 2021–2025, excluding major event days, means of annual values. Dominion and 11 peers: twelve large investor-owned utilities in PJM and the Southeast, selected by EIA ID before results were computed; medians exclude Dominion.

County-days with storms had about 12 times the outage hours of calm days



11.9×

storm vs calm county-days (95% CI 7.9–16.9)

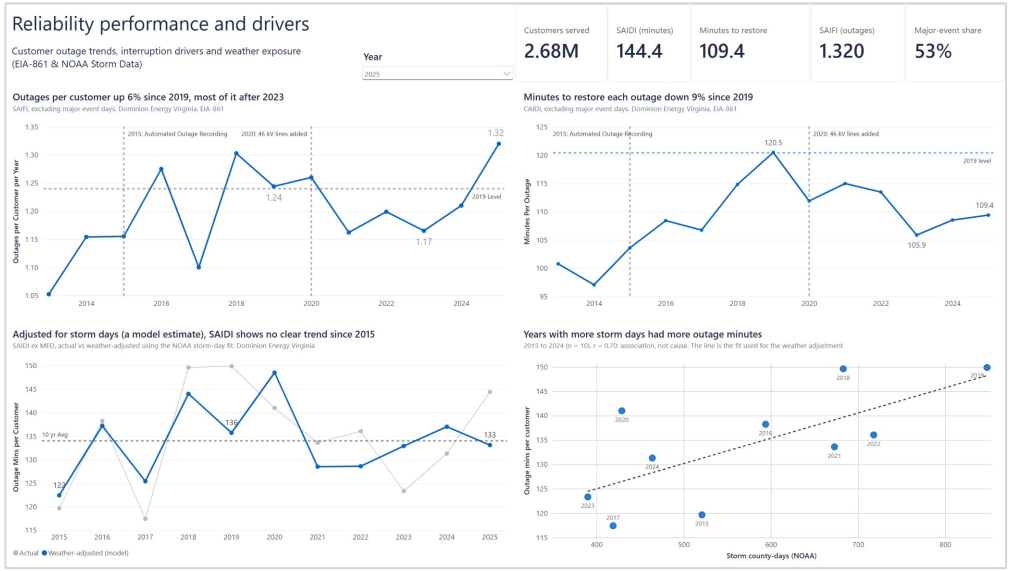
Holds on non-major days (9.9×), in Dominion-only counties (19.9×) and in every year 2015–2025.

EAGLE-I counts every utility's customers in a county. An association: storm reports partly follow damage.

Why it matters: reporting reliability next to storm exposure would keep a stormy year from being read as a trend.

Source: EAGLE-I (ORNL) and NOAA Storm Events, 2015–2025: 6,108 storm county-days with complete outage readings, 99 counties on the map (EAGLE-I); complete days only (2025: 74% of county-days). 95% intervals: 2,000 resamples of whole days.

The Power BI report: one page per question, on customer-weighted measures



FCT_RELIABILITY
utility × state × year

many:1

DIM_UTILITY
peer group

18 tables through one DataFolder parameter (Import); 11 pages, ending on Data notes: 31 tests, 12 of 12 reconciled.

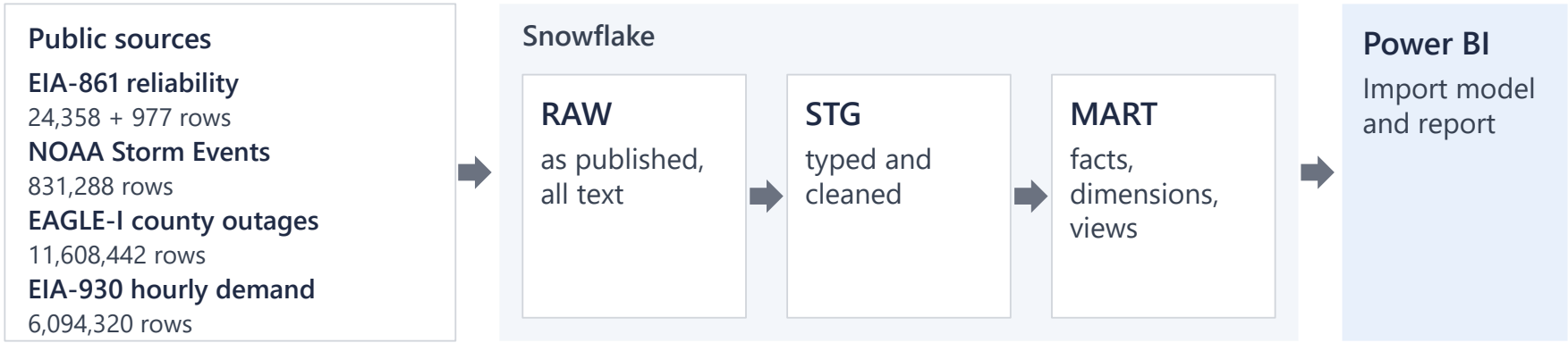
Customer-weighted measures; the cards follow the year slicer:

```
Selected SAIDI =
VAR SelectedYear =
    SELECTEDVALUE('Dashboard Year'[Year], 2025)
RETURN
    CALCULATE([SAIDI ex MED],
        FCT_RELIABILITY[YEAR] = SelectedYear)
```

Why it matters: Power BI reporting leads the role's duties, and the same model and measures could carry a program-tracking report.

Source: Power BI Desktop, the project's report: Summary page, year 2025. Tables are the mart's CSV exports, imported through a folder parameter; measures as in the project's measures.dax.

Built with production habits: tested, documented, and reconciled to the reported numbers



31 tests pass

12 on the reliability mart, 19 on the new tables

Data dictionary

every table and column; measures defined in docs/05

Decisions log

decisions logged (D1–D22); the peer set was chosen by EIA ID before results

Reconciled

12 of 12 rebuilt values match the published figures: a check of definitions

Why it matters: the same habits would serve the team's reports: reconcile first, test every load, write each definition down.

Source: Project build: SQL scripts, tests T1–T31 (12 on the reliability mart), data dictionary, decisions log D1–D22; row counts as loaded.

With Dominion's outage, meter and circuit data: the questions I'd bring and what I'd build

Days 1–30

Learn and reconcile

Learn how outages, meter events and circuits are recorded and reported.

Rebuild one year's SAIDI, SAIFI and CAIDI and reconcile them to the filed figures.

Deliverable: a reconciled baseline with written definitions

Days 31–60

Ask about frequency

By circuit and cause code, storm days apart from calm days; repeat interruptions (CEMIn).

Outage times from meter last-gasp and restore messages (99.8% of meters are smart), checked against OMS.

Deliverable: tested views and a data dictionary

Days 61–90

Build the tracking report

Track mainfeeder hardening against matched untreated feeders (same pre-period performance), weather-normalized, in support of the program's selection rule.

Deliverable: a Power BI program-tracking report, refreshed on a schedule

Why it matters: these are questions to check first with the people who own each definition, not conclusions.

Source: A plan: Dominion data is named by type only, and none was used here. Smart meters: EIA-861 2025 (advanced meters as a share of all meters). Grid Resiliency: Dominion Energy website, read November 1, 2026.

Three takeaways: a stormier year, a frequency gap, and storms by county

1 **A stormier year**
More storms and more interruptions in 2025; no clear trend once storms are counted

2 **Frequency is the peer gap**
So causes are the question, and answering it needs outage records by cause code

3 **Storms by county**
Storm county-days carry far more outage hours, so report reliability beside storm exposure

I've built a tested Snowflake → Power BI pipeline on public reliability data.

How my experience maps Mercury Insurance, Data Analyst

Snowflake pipeline, 20M+ rows
→ this project's mart

Root-cause analysis on joined data
→ what I'd do with cause codes in the first 90 days

Metadata and business definitions
→ the data dictionary

Thank you. I'd like to do this work with your team.

Source: Takeaways: slides 2–4. Experience: Mercury Insurance, Data Analyst, 2026 to present.

Definitions: SAIDI = SAIFI × CAIDI, and major event days are set aside by rule

SAIDI
outage minutes per customer per year

=

SAIFI
interruptions per customer per year: how often

×

CAIDI
minutes per interruption: how long

Dominion 2025: 1.320 × 109.4 = 144.4 minutes (excluding major event days)

Major event days (MED): IEEE 1366's 2.5 beta method takes five years of daily SAIDI, drops zero days, and sets α and β as the mean and standard deviation of ln(daily SAIDI); a day above exp(α + 2.5β) is an MED.

Dominion reports to EIA under a non-IEEE rule ("Other" in EIA-861); most peers in this deck use IEEE 1366.

With major event days, 2025 SAIDI was 306.7 minutes, against 144.4 without them: MEDs held 53%.

Log split: ln(SAIDI ratio) = ln(SAIFI ratio) + ln(CAIDI ratio). From 2022, duration fell, so frequency accounts for more than all of the rise; from 2023, 79%.

Source: IEEE Std 1366; EIA-861 reliability, Dominion Energy Virginia, 2022, 2023 and 2025.

The weather fit is a check on one year, not a forecast

Year	Storm county-days	SAIDI ex-MED	From the fit	Difference
2015	521	119.6	131.3	−11.6
2016	594	138.2	135.0	+3.2
2017	419	117.4	126.0	−8.6
2018	683	149.6	139.7	+9.9
2019	848	149.9	148.2	+1.7
2020	429	141.0	126.5	+14.5
2021	673	133.6	139.1	−5.5
2022	718	136.0	141.5	−5.4
2023	390	123.3	124.5	−1.1
2024	464	131.3	128.3	+3.0
2025 (not in fit)	**791**	**144.4**	**145.3**	**−0.9**

Fit on 2015–2024 (n = 10): SAIDI = 104.3 + 0.0518 × storm county-days; r = 0.70 (t = 2.75, p = 0.025; 95% CI 0.12 to 0.92), R^2 0.49.

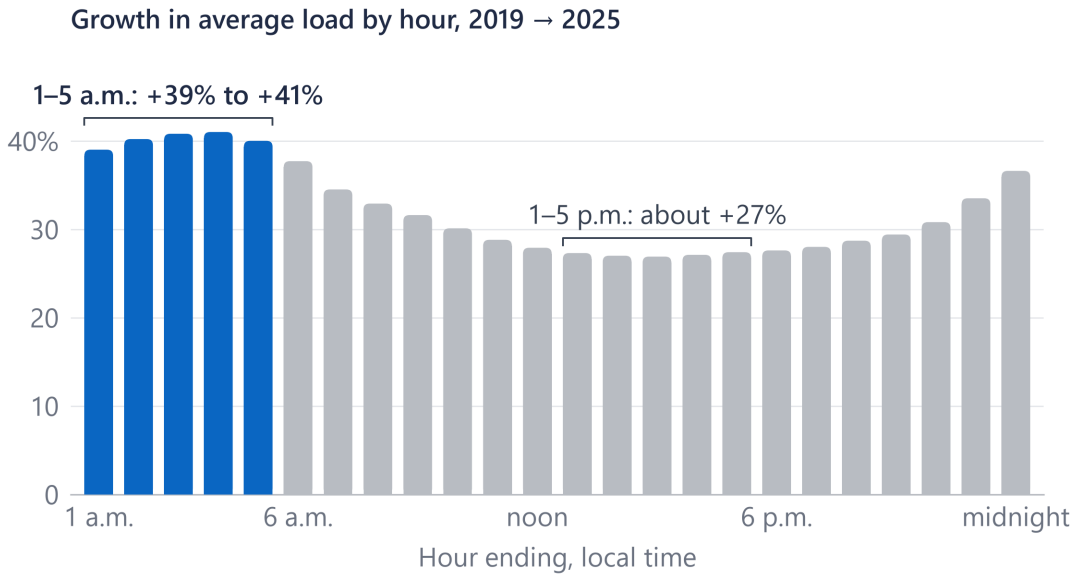
Why 2015: the change to automated outage recording that year shifts the level (decision D6).

2025, left out of the fit: 145.3 from the fit (95% prediction interval 122.3–168.2), 144.4 actual.

Adjusted for storm days, the trend since 2015 is not distinguishable from zero: about +0.3 minutes a year (95% range −1.4 to +2.1).

Source: NOAA Storm Events and EIA-861, 2015–2025; ordinary least squares on ten annual points (exploratory). Storm county-days count Bedford city once (decision D22).

Overnight demand grew faster than afternoon demand; winter rivals summer for the peak



+39–41%

average load, hours ending 1–5 a.m., 2019 → 2025 (1–5 p.m.: about +27%)

Winter

set the yearly peak in 2019, 2022 and 2025; 2026 so far: winter 25,413 vs summer 25,384 MW, a tie

Highest hour of the year +26%, lowest hour +52%.

I'd add winter and overnight views to load and outage reports.

Source: EIA-930 hourly demand, PJM Dominion (DOM) zone, which is wider than Dominion's retail territory; 2019 and 2025 full years; 2026 to the hour ending midnight, Oct 29. Winter = Dec–Feb, summer = Jun–Aug.

Every number traces to a public source; the tables behind them are tested after each load

Source	Publisher	Years	Grain	Rows
EIA-861 Reliability, 2025 final	EIA	2025	utility × state × year	977
PUDL EIA-861 reliability	Catalyst Cooperative	2013–2024	utility × state × year	24,358
EIA-861 Service Territory	EIA	2025	utility × county	11,803
NOAA Storm Events	NOAA NCEI	2013–2025	storm event	831,288
EAGLE-I county outages	ORNL for DOE	Nov 2014–2025	county × 15 minutes	11,608,442
EIA-930 hourly demand	EIA	Jul 2018–Oct 2026	region × hour	6,094,320
HURDAT2 storm tracks	NOAA NHC	1851–2025	storm × 6-hour fix	55,524
DOE-417 disturbance reports	DOE	2014–2025	reported event	3,702
CPC degree days	NOAA CPC	2018–Oct 2026	state × day	309,504
Dominion Energy 2025 Annual Report	Dominion Energy	2025	document (130, 133)	reference

Tests T1–T31, all pass: T1–T12 on the reliability mart (no duplicate keys; SAIDI = SAIFI × CAIDI within 2%; Dominion 2025 equals EIA's published 306.7, 144.4 and 2,675,735 customers); T13–T31 on the county outage, storm and load tables. **Reconciled 12 of 12** against the annual report and the EIA-861 files.

Source: Project documentation: sources register (publisher, vintage, license) and data-quality tests; all public data.

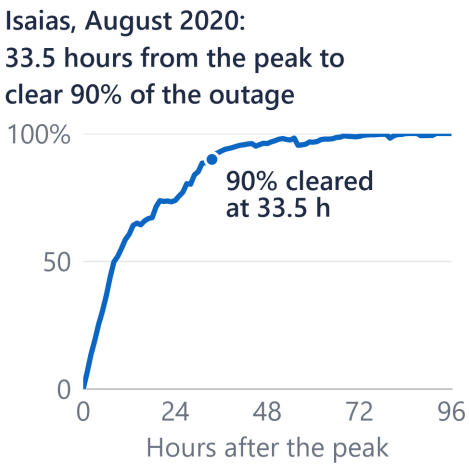
What public data cannot show, and what would answer it

Public data limit	What would answer it (Dominion data, by type)
One number per utility per year (EIA-861)	Outage records by event, circuit and cause
Storms counted by county, not by line	Outage records with cause codes and circuit location
Methods differ between utilities	Dominion's daily SAIDI and its filing method
The DOM zone is wider than the retail territory	Meter interval data by circuit
No customer identities: growth can't be attributed	Customer class and large-load records

Source: Project scope limits (decision D14) and the sources above.

The ten largest outage events since 2014: three tropical, two winter, five wind

#	Peak day	Storm type	Peak customers out	Held 1 h	Hours to clear 90%
1	Oct 12, 2018	Tropical (Michael)	558,729	545,548	60.5
2	Mar 2, 2018	Wind	419,136	401,776	55.0
3	**Aug 4, 2020**	**Tropical (Isaias)**	**351,738**	**343,492**	**33.5**
4	Jan 3, 2022	Winter	314,644	308,015	102.8
5	Feb 13, 2021	Winter	281,707	271,359	101.5
6	Oct 9, 2016	Tropical (Matthew)	269,298	265,401	52.8
7	Jun 16, 2016	Wind	234,951	233,003	65.8
8	Jun 19, 2025	Wind	225,609	209,475	22.0
9	Feb 16, 2025	Wind	187,074	172,538	20.3
10	May 14, 2018	Wind	159,532	151,385	20.0



Source: EAGLE-I (ORNL), all utilities in Dominion's 103 counties, Nov 2014–2025; storm type from NOAA and HURDAT2. Cleared = (peak − customers out) ÷ (peak − pre-event level): a net count, not a utility's "% of affected customers restored".